2.26 Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia (BPH)

Prostrate is a gland about the size of a walnut and is present only in males. It lies below the urinary bladder and surrounds the urethra. The prostate secrete a fluid that helps to nourish sperm as part of the semen (ejaculatory fluid). It is a noncancerous enlargement or hypertrophy of the prostate.

Definition

A benign (not cancer) condition in which an over growth of prostane tissue pushes against the urethra and bladder, blocking the flow of urine.

Risk factors

- Aging occurs after 50- 80 years.
- Family history
- Obesity
- Diabetes
- Heart diseases.
- Diabetes and heart diseases and use of beta blockers
- Obesity
- Ethnicity Black men may get symptoms at a younger age.

Causes

- Hormonal changes androgen/estrogen imbalance
- Neoplastic theory is of all the elements of prostoke
- Frequency

Signs and Symptoms

- Hesitancy, urgency, weak stream and straining to pass urine
- Nocturia
- Acute retention of urine
- Chronic retention of urine
- Dribbling or leaking during urination after urination

Diagnosis

- History collection
- Physical examination -digital rectal exam to check the size and shape of the prostate.
- Urine culture and sensitivity to rule out infection
- Uroflowmetry: Urine flow test to measure the urine stream.
- Measurement of post voidal residual volume
- PSA (Prostate-Specific Antigen) blood test. High PSA levels are a sign of a large prostate.
- Ultra Sonogram
- Biopsy to rule out cancer.
- Cystocopy as part of treatment.

Management

Medical

- Alpha blockers- relax the muscles of the prostate and neck of the bladder.
- 5-Alpha Reductase Inhibitors (5-ARIs)- shrinks the prostate and prevents additional growth.
- Phosphodiesterase 5 Inhibitors (PDE5 inhibitors) - relieves the symptoms and increases the flow rate of urine

Surgical

- Transvesical suprapubic Prostatectomy
- Transurethral resection of the prostate (TURP)
- Retropubic prostatectomy.

Nursing

- Ensure patient voids at regular intervals
- Provide warm environment as cold worsens the symptoms

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